



ABACUS

Counting Happiness

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter

MATHEMATICIANS OF HAPPINESS
BSG
Statistics Department
Cherishing one single individual



Joyful gathering of
Mathematicians of Happiness



EVERY CAUSE IN THE DISTRICT OPENS THE WAY TO WORLDWIDE KOSEN-RUFU

Dear Mathematicians of Happiness,

Heartiest congratulations for holding successful and joyful zone level statistics incharges meetings last month. We received such inspiring reports of statistics incharges coming together, chanting and sharing their deep joy in taking care of statistics and members. Truly, this collective spirit is a source of great hope as we now advance joyfully towards our November 18th campaign with the powerful theme- **“District Kosen-rufu is Worldwide Kosen-rufu”**.

Ikeda Sensei quotes Nichiren Daishonin and reminds us,
“Nichiren Daishonin declared with affection and sternness to a disciple striving valiantly in Suruga Province, ‘I entrust you with the propagation of Buddhism in your province.’ All of you are Bodhisattvas of the Earth, who have been entrusted with ‘your province’ – or, in today’s terms, ‘your district’ – directly by the Buddha of the Latter Day”

(Guidelines for Kosen-rufu, Victory and Happiness, p. 2).

Sensei’s guidance reaffirms that it is our districts that will pave the way for worldwide kosen-rufu, and

in this journey, each one of us is the protagonist. Among us, our precious district statistics incharges are truly the linchpins of this movement. They are the first to welcome a new life—whether through an introduction or a transfer—and they cherish each one on BDS with the same sincerity as meeting and encouraging them in person.

Their noble efforts—responding to introductions and transfers, helping new members connect to faith and practice, diligently marking attendance, and keeping records updated—directly contribute to the growth of the district. And when our districts grow, kosen-rufu advances, opening wide the gateway to victories in our own lives.

This spirit is in perfect rhythm with our **November 18 Campaign**, where districts across India are advancing joyfully with Daimoku–Home Visits–Shakubuku (DHS) at the core. Through abundant daimoku, warm home visits, nurturing new friends in faith, courageous shakubuku, and study, we are laying the foundation for victory in each district, victory in each member’s life, and ultimately, victory for worldwide kosen-rufu.

With this conviction, let us forge ahead joyfully, building soaring districts that shine brilliantly with actual proof. Let’s advance boldly towards Nov 18th with yet another milestone in the history of kosen-rufu.

- By ABACUS Editorial Team ★★

ENCOURAGEMENT IS AN EXPRESSION OF RESPECT AND TRUST

“Let us encourage each other/ and advance together”—these words in Mr. Toda’s New Year poem are the very essence of the practice of the humanistic teachings of Nichiren Buddhism.

Encouragement is by no means a one-way street. It is mutual; we encourage and are encouraged, striving and advancing together, as Mr. Toda says.

And the foundation for encouragement is trust and respect for the other person. Genuine encouragement is born from a wholehearted belief in people’s inherent dignity and innate capacity for good.

It was based on this powerful conviction that President Toda tirelessly encouraged those overwhelmed by life’s sorrows or weighed down by karmic suffering. Regarding each person as a noble and precious individual possessing the Buddha nature, he continued to impart to them the light of hope. As Mr. Toda’s devoted disciple, I have also dedicated myself fully to encouraging others.

The actions of Bodhisattva Never Disparaging, who appears in the Lotus Sutra, stand as a model of this kind of encouragement.

“Never disparaging” signifies respecting others. Because we respect the life of every person we encounter, we can help them rouse courage deep from inside and powerfully bring forth their inherent life force. In addition, when we encourage others, we ourselves are also encouraged. Showing respect to others strengthens and endlessly enriches our own lives as well.

(VC, Dec 2020, p. 11-12) ★★

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

“With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu.”



ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

“A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today.”

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)



JOURNEY OF FAITH: FROM BEING FOSTERED TO FOSTERING OTHERS

Khushi Budhwani

**Zone Statistics Incharge
West India - 2 Area**



Scan to listen to
the experience

My journey in faith began 21 years ago as a shy timid girl with very low self-esteem. With the warmth and love of the Soka Gakkai leaders who fostered and treasured me, I have been able to grow in my understanding of the philosophy and develop a deep connection with Sensei.

Sensei says, ***'A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, his life pulsates, her personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and***

rebirth is played out' (BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. 39).

Today, my responsibility as a Gakkai leader and statistics incharge has given me the opportunity to help others come closer to Sensei and experience the life transforming benefits of embracing the Gohonzon, just as I did.

In Juhu Vile Parle Zone, we had active 4-divisional leaders with youth always taking the lead. However, this May, three of our leaders graduated, leaving

just 2 MDs and me to drive the zone. With daimoku as my starting point, I began each morning with opening the BDS, chanting for each life and praying with a strong ichinen to connect with inactive members. As a result, some members who had been inactive have started attending meetings again, while others have agreed to meet one-on-one. I also started updating the BDS to ensure that everyone gets the correct information.

Accelerating the momentum towards examination, some FDS besides members from our zone have also registered for the entrance exam and some youth division members have already started preparing for the intermediate exam.

In the past, many districts had missed out on marking the attendance. As a zone statistics incharge, I took complete responsibility to resolve this and encouraged other statistics incharges. In one district where there was no active statistics incharge, the district chief—who was initially hesitant because she was not familiar with the BDS—challenged herself and took up this responsibility. She not only learned to operate the system but also became one of the first DSI in the zone to mark attendance immediately after meetings.

On a personal front, I started my career as a self-taught freelance graphic designer in 2015. Lacking formal training, I often undervalued my work, undercharged, and was frequently pressured into delivering beyond my scope within the same budget. On January 2nd this year, I promised Sensei that I would respect and value my work and never allow

anyone to take me for granted. I began focusing more on quality rather than quantity, while giving justice to my responsibilities in work, Gakkai, and family. Around that time, I reached out to an old client who owed me a large six-figure amount and had disappeared three years earlier, ignoring all my messages. To my surprise, he not only responded but cleared all dues within three days.

For the Women's Symposium, I was assigned the responsibility of welcome committee. Just days before, my mother fractured her pelvic bone and was hospitalised. Mystically, the hospital was only two minutes from the kaikan, enabling me to attend preparatory meetings while caring for her. She was discharged a day before the symposium, but the insurance claim was rejected, and after endless calls and procedures, we could bring her home only at midnight. Despite this, I gave my best to the meeting and even invited a guest who felt deeply inspired by the warmth and energy there.

My fight towards the symposium filled me with renewed courage, and within 15 days the insurance company reimbursed the expenses. My mother, bedridden for a month, created great value by chanting daimoku with visiting leaders and even hosting meetings at home. I am happy to share that she has now begun walking again and recently took her first steps outside.

I am determined to strive my hardest and treasure each life. I will begin each day by winning in gongyo and daimoku and report monumental victories in the zone by November 18.





Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the '**Discussion Meeting**' attendance in the month of August 2025

We accord these zones as '**MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH**' for August

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

Ananda – Lotus
Expressway – Jaypee
Greno West
Indirapuram
Noida – Vasundhara
Noida City Centre
Noida West

Delhi - North

Central Pitampura
Delhi University
Mansarovar – Naraina
Model Town – Chatrasal
Paschim Vihar – Punjabi Bagh
Pusa
Rajouri
Rohini

Delhi - South

Badkal – Faridabad
CR Park – Kalkaji
Charmwood
Kailash
Lajpat Nagar
Lodhi Garden
New Friends Colony
Sainik Farm
Saket
Sarita Vihar

North India

Amritsar
Chandigarh
Jaipur Midtown
Jammu
Lucknow
Lucknow – Gorakhpur
Madhya Pradesh
Mansarovar
Mohali
Panchkula West
Rajasthan South

East India

Behala – Joka
Central Kolkata
Dumdum
Howrah
Salt Lake-Himalayan
South Central
Tolly Jadavpur – Bihar

South India

AP – Telangana (North)
Bangalore South Central
Bangalore South East
Chennai Central
Chennai East
Chennai West

Delhi - West

DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka – Palam
Dwarka – Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
SBTG
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikasपुरी

West India - 1

Ahmedabad Central
Baroda
Goregaon Malad East
Goregaon Malad West
Kandivali East Dahisar
Mulund Ghatkopar
Nasik – Aurangabad
Powai
Pune South 1
Pune South Hills
Surat
Thane – Kalyan

West India - 2

Bandra
Chembur – Ghatkopar
Gateway
Goa
Juhu Link – Yari Road
Juhu Vile Parle
Khar Santacruz BKC
Navi Mumbai
Sion Parel
Tardeo Malabar

MEETINGS IN SEPTEMBER 2025

6th September 2025

Student Division Meeting



Region Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

14th September 2025

Discussion Meeting



District Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!



HAPPINESS COUNTER



Youth Division

1 4 2 2 4 6



All India

2 8 8 4 4 3

Q. How does 'Member Introduction' feature work in the BDS?

We can use the introduction feature in the BDS to introduce the new guests to Nichiren Daishonin's Buddhism only when they reside outside our district.

By raising an introduction request in BDS, we can notify the district closest to the new guest's residence about their interest in joining Nichiren Daishonin's Buddhism. The district statistics incharge (DSI) upon receiving the introduction request, ensures that someone from the district meets the new guest in person and invites them to the discussion meeting.

Once the new guest attends the meeting, the DSI adds the new guest in the BDS as a New Friend (*Read more about this in the article*).

Important points pertaining to an introduction:

- An introduction request can be raised on BDS through **all logins** – District/Chapter/Region/Zone/Area.
- **To raise an introduction**, we need to login to BDS, click on '**Introduction**' followed by '**Create**', then fill the details and submit (*See the image A*).

The screenshot shows the 'New Introduction' form in the BDS system. The form is divided into several sections. On the left, there is a sidebar with navigation options: Introduction (Create, View), Friends, Members, Reports, Meeting Attendance, Archive Attendance, Gohonzon, BDS Contents, Appointment, Ticket System, and Logout. The main form area has the following fields:

- Name ***: Text input field.
- Address ***: Text input field.
- Pincode**: Text input field.
- State ***: Dropdown menu.
- City ***: Dropdown menu.
- Contact Number ***: Text input field.
- Email Address**: Text input field.
- Division ***: Dropdown menu.
- Sub Division**: Dropdown menu.
- Nationality/Country ***: Dropdown menu.
- Organization Structure**: A series of dropdown menus for Area, Zone, Region, Chapter, and District.
- Do you want to find the name of the introducer?**: A toggle switch set to 'No'.
- Introducer's Name ***: Text input field.
- Introducer's Contact Number ***: Text input field.
- Introducer's Email Address**: Text input field.
- Zone Locator**: A link with an external icon.

At the bottom of the form, there are 'Submit' and 'Cancel' buttons.

(A)

- **Once the introduction request is received** in the district, the DSI can see the request under **Introduction >>View >>To the Structure**. The DSI gets three options against the name of the new guest – **View**, **Reject** and **Make New Friend** (See the image B).

(B)

The screenshot shows the 'Welcome to BDS' interface. On the left, a sidebar menu includes 'Introduction', 'Friends', 'Members', and 'Reports'. The 'Introduction' section is active, showing a list of introduction requests. The table has columns: INTRODUCTION DETAILS, DIVISION, ADDRESS AND STRUCTURE, INITIATOR SI DETAILS, ADDRESS AND STRUCTURE, TARGET SI, INTRODUCED BY, and ACTION. A specific request for Priyanka Juneja is highlighted, showing details like '4 Block', 'Delhi - North', and 'Rajinder Nagar/ Old Rajender Nagar/ 4 block'. The 'ACTION' column for this entry shows three buttons: 'View' (with an eye icon), 'Reject', and 'Make New Friend'.

- Click on the **View** option to see the details of the new guest such as their name, address, contact number etc. (See the image C).

(C)

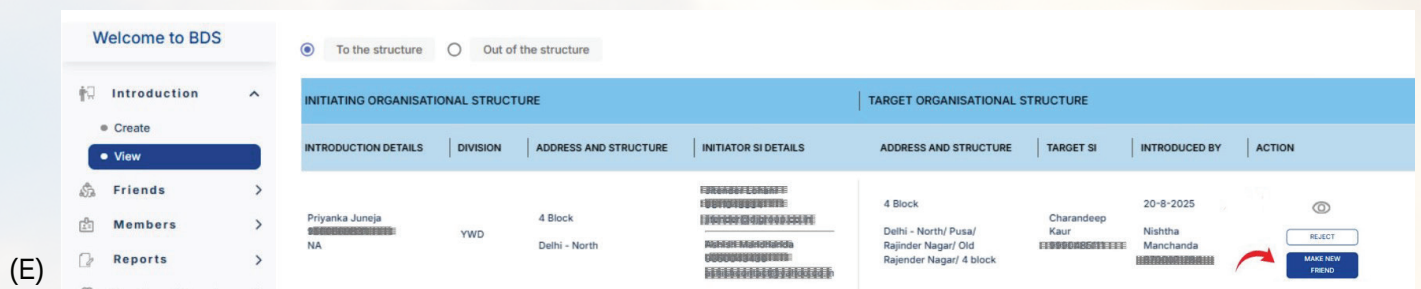
The screenshot shows a 'View Introduction Form' dialog box. It contains various input fields for personal and organizational information. On the left, fields include Name (Priyanka Juneja), Address (4 Block), State (Delhi), Contact Number, Division (YWD), Nationality/Country (India), Introducer's Name (Nishtha Manchanda), and Introducer's Email Address. On the right, there is an 'Organization Structure' section with dropdown menus for Area (Delhi - North), Zone (Pusa), Region (Rajinder Nagar), Chapter (Old Rajender Nagar), and District (4 block). Other fields include Pincode, City (New Delhi), Email Address, Sub Division, and Introducer's Contact Number.

- Click on the **Reject** option to reject an introduction request if it does not belong to your district (See the image D).

(D)

The screenshot shows a 'Reject Introduction' dialog box. It features a text input field with the placeholder 'Enter your remark here...'. Below the input field are two buttons: 'REJECT' and 'CANCEL'.

- Click on **Make New Friend** to add the new guest as a **New Friend** (See the image E)

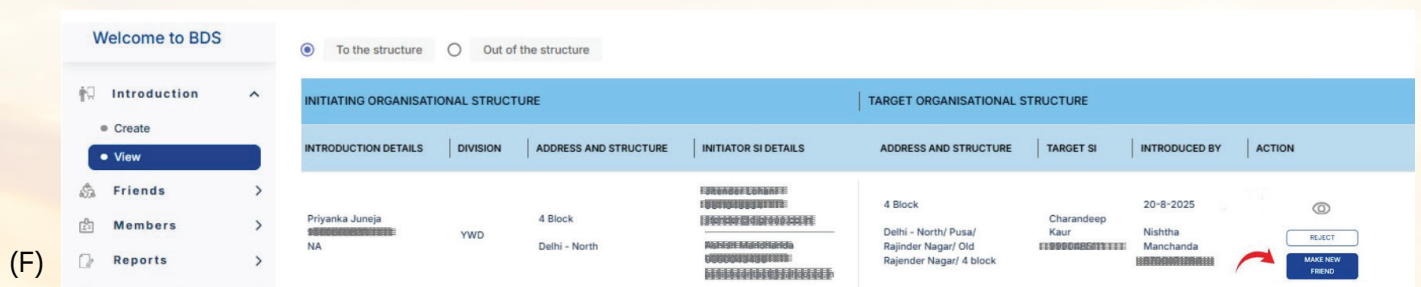


Read more about it in the following section!

Q. How to accept an introduction request to the district?

Accepting an introduction request to the district means making the new guest a New Friend in the BDS. This can be done in two ways by the DSI.

- By clicking on the **Make New Friend** option against the name of the new guest (See the image F).



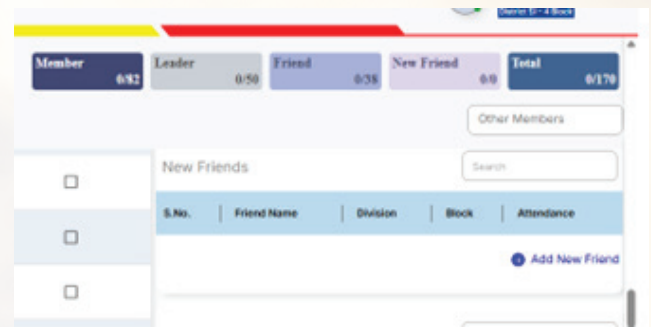
A window opens with the new guest's details pre-filled. Assign the block and submit. The new guest will be added as New Friend (See the image G).

(G)

The screenshot shows a 'Change to New Friend' form. At the top, there's a header with a menu icon, the title 'Change to New Friend', a user profile for 'District Chief - Deputy' (CK), and a role 'District SI - 4 Block'. Below the header is a red warning banner: 'Attention: Kindly note that by accepting this introduction you will register a New Friend and that it would be counted towards this month's Discussion Meeting attendance. Please proceed only if certain.' The form is divided into two main sections. The left section contains input fields for: 'New Friend Name' (pre-filled with 'Priyanka Juneja'), 'Address' (pre-filled with '4 Block'), 'State' (dropdown with 'Delhi'), 'Contact Number' (masked), 'Division' (dropdown with 'YWD'), 'Profession' (dropdown), 'Introducer's Name' (pre-filled with 'Nishtha Manchanda'), and 'Introducer's Email Address' (masked). The right section, titled 'Organization Structure', contains a series of dropdown menus: 'Area' (pre-filled with 'Delhi - North'), 'Zone' (pre-filled with 'Pusa'), 'Region' (pre-filled with 'Rajinder Nagar'), 'Chapter' (pre-filled with 'Old Rajender Nagar'), 'District' (pre-filled with '4 block'), and 'Block' (empty). At the bottom are 'Submit' and 'Cancel' buttons.

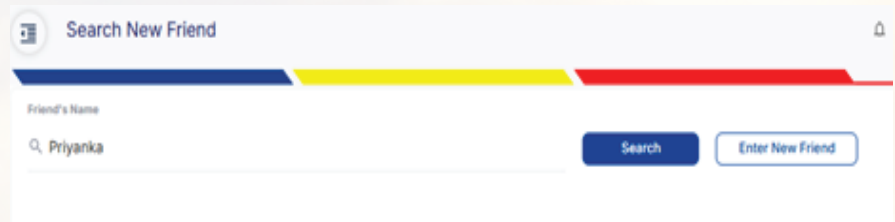
2. And, while marking the discussion meeting attendance for the month.

- Click on '**Meeting attendance**'
- Select '**Discussion**' from the drop down of 'Meeting Type'
- Click on '**Add New Friend**', you get two options '**Search**' and '**Enter New Friend**' (See the image H).

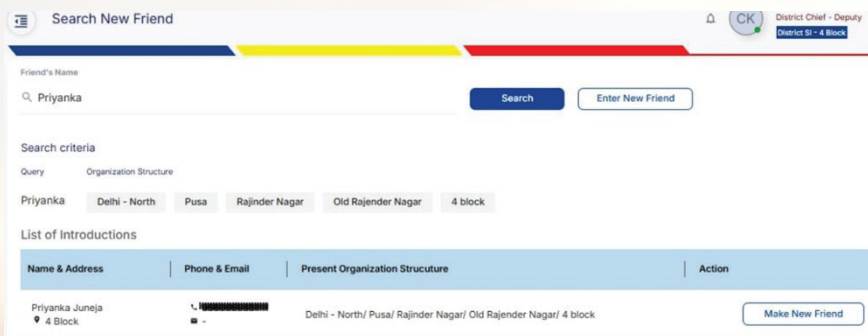


(H)

- Click on '**Search**' and enter the name whose introduction request you wish to accept and click search (See the image I).



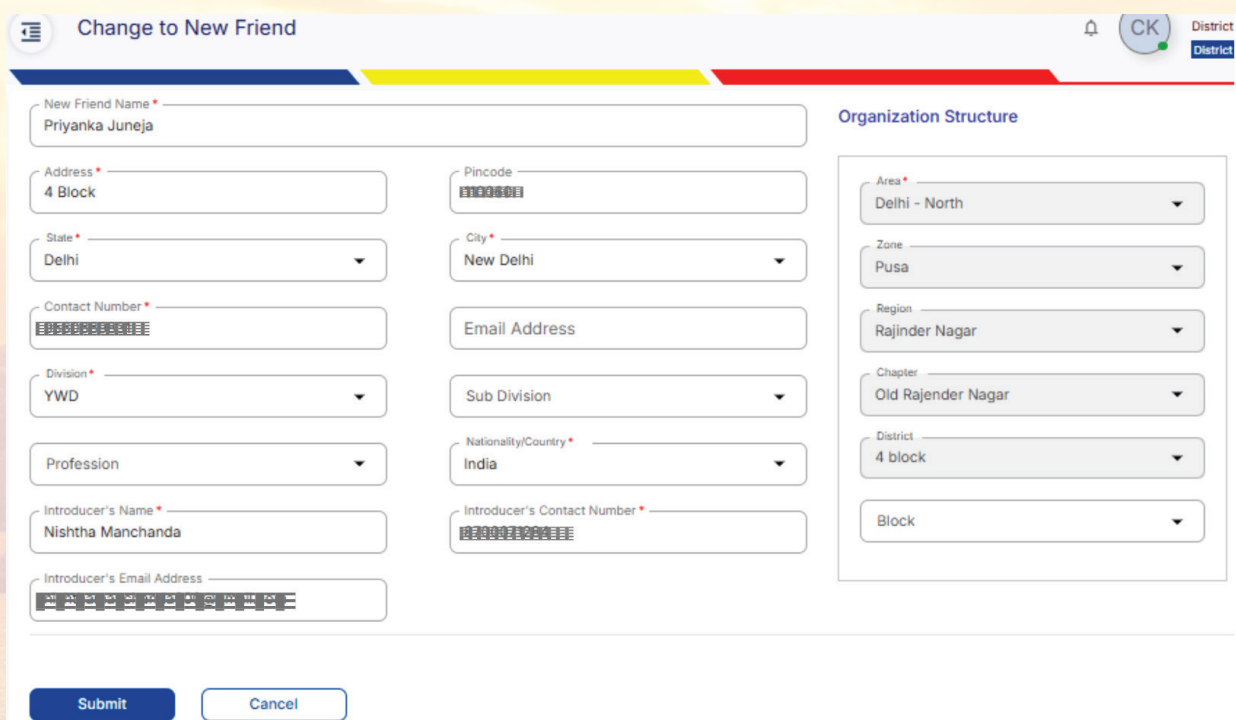
(I)



(J)

- A window opens reflecting the details of the person whose introduction needs to be accepted. We can just click on '**Make New Friend**' to do the same (See the image J).

- A window opens with the new guest's details pre-filled. Assign the block and submit. The new guest will be added as New Friend (See the image K).



(K)

Role of Chapter /Region / Zone /Area statistics incharges when an introduction request is received

- When an introduction request is received at **Chapter /Region / Zone /Area level**, the respective statistics incharge can see the request under **Introduction >>View >>To the Structure**. The respective statistics incharge gets two options against the name of the new guest – **👁 (View)** and **Assign**. (See the image L).

(L)

The screenshot shows the 'Pending Introduction' screen in the BDS system. The user is Raghav Kumar, Zone Chief. The screen displays a table with columns for 'INITIATING ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE' and 'TARGET ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE'. The table contains details for a new guest, Dimple Gupta, and the initiator, Sumita Marwah. The 'ACTION' column shows a 'View' icon (👁) and an 'Assign' button. The interface also includes a sidebar with navigation options like 'Introduction', 'Friends', 'Members', and 'Reports'.

- Click on the **👁 (View)** option to see the details of the new guest such as their name, address, contact number etc.
- Click on **'Assign'** to select and send that introduction request to the particular structure.





ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Nidhi Banka

District Statistics Incharge, West India - 1 Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

I began supporting my district statistics incharge with MDS (*now BDS*) in 2017 as she was not quite comfortable with the technical aspects. Initially, I stepped in to help my district, but soon it became an opportunity for me to overcome my fear of statistics as the most difficult subject.

Over time, I learned all aspects of MDS (*now BDS*) and realized that statistics is not just about numbers but about lives. And it is the statistics

incharges who encounter and cherish each life – through introduction, transfer, updating records, attendance etc. This deepened my vow to treasure each life by reporting accurately and promptly.

As I continued to learn and work on the MDS (*now BDS*), I became a “24/7 statistics helpline” for fellow statistics incharges. In 2020 I was appointed chapter statistics incharge, overseeing three districts. With guidance from senior incharges, I deepened my understanding of MDS (*now BDS*) and became more diligent in maintaining statistics.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

This responsibility transformed me personally. Preparing statistics reports across districts polished my excel skills so much that today I independently manage all my business accounting, file my returns, and no longer depend on anyone for technical help.

Although due to division graduation, I was relieved from my statistics responsibility, I still attended every BDS training, eager to stay updated. I shared my learnings with fellow incharges, ensuring that we grew together.

However, when I later became a district statistics incharge again, I resolved to have accurate information on MDS (now BDS) and trailblazing speed in my actions. Further, I recently made a presentation on the importance of ABACUS and could encourage all those who have not been reading ABACUS yet. Earnest causes brought many victories, including my selection for the for Daiseido Training Programme.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

I think BDS is user-friendly and saves time and effort. I find it very convenient to introduce a life anywhere in the country just at the click of a button, using the 'Locate Zone' feature.

The family module is particularly helpful, allowing members of the same family to be linked together, which was earlier difficult. Also, applying for the Gohonzon has become so simpler.

Most importantly, attendance marking through the app saves time and empowers members to be more self-reliant.



Do you read the ABACUS regularly? What do you think is the importance of ABACUS personally for you?

Yes, I read ABACUS regularly and find it very useful.

I use the puzzle in discussion meetings, as they help members understand the basics of faith and practice. I also share content during home visits—the experiences and guidance give practical insights into member care.

I feel awareness about ABACUS is still low. If one page in the VC could be dedicated to ABACUS highlights, more members would connect with this valuable newsletter.



What is your determination as statistics incharge towards 2030?

My determination is to -

1. Expand awareness of ABACUS among leaders and statistics incharges so that everyone understands the true spirit of being a statistics incharge.

2. Have accurate information on BDS, increased membership with new friends joining, inactive members to become absolutely active and awakened to their mission.

3. Hold at least 300 dialogues and do 50 Shakubuku till November 18, 2026, and foster capable leaders by 2030. ★★



THE PATH OF FAITH

President Ikeda teaches that faith is a journey of growth—starting with encouragement, nurtured by care, deepened through study, and expanded by dialogue. Each step reveals life's limitless treasures and leads to happiness and peace. Fill in the blanks to trace this journey of faith.

1. A single word of encouragement can plant the ____ ( - 4 letters) of Buddhahood.
2. When challenges arise, we turn them into _____ ( - 13 letters).
3. Dialogue and study make our roots of practice _____ ( - 6 letters).
4. Through countless efforts, we accumulate the _____ of the heart ( - 9 letters).
5. With compassion & care, the seed begins to ____ ( - 4 letters).
6. With unity, we build a _____ ( - 7 letters) of peace and harmony.
7. To treasure those making sincere efforts for kosen-rufu is the essence of genuine _____ ( - 8 letters).
8. Strong faith leads to unlimited _____ ( - 9 letters).
9. This unending rhythm of practice leads to boundless ____ ( - 3 letters).
10. Dedicating ourselves to the Mystic Law brings vast and immeasurable _____ ( - 7 letters).

Please send your answers at statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org by 30th September 2025

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

1. Treasuring each individual - is the heart of the people-oriented philosophy, or humanism, of the Lotus Sutra.
2. The outcome of a struggle is - decided by the leaders' determination, by their sense of responsibility.
3. What makes us admirable as practitioners of Nichiren Buddhism - Not background, social position, or inherent abilities, but our tireless efforts to support our fellow members and help them become happy.

4. Become the kind of leaders whom others regard as - a source of reassurance, clarity, peace of mind, and courage—people who inspire confidence and hope.
5. The most important people - are those in our immediate environment right now.
6. Striving to bring happiness and joy to others, - even though we may be struggling with problems ourselves, is the mark of bodhisattvas.
7. However hard we may have exerted ourselves in the past, - the important thing is how we challenge ourselves from now on.
8. The mentor-disciple relationship is the - essence of Nichiren Buddhism and the heart of the Soka Gakkai spirit.
9. The fundamental attitude of Soka Gakkai leaders must always be - to value their fellow members to the highest degree and serve them sincerely.
10. The votary of the Lotus Sutra welcomes - hardships, eagerly awaits them, and then rises joyfully to challenge them.

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ★ Anushka Harwani – North India | ★ Ritu Kumar – Delhi North |
| ★ Aruna Patra – West India 1 | ★ Romi Agarwal – Delhi West |
| ★ Indrani Ghosh – Delhi South | ★ Sangita Shetty – West India 2 |
| ★ Jaya Chatterjee – East India | ★ Shobha Dube – Delhi North |
| ★ Kavita Matlani – Delhi West | ★ Shubhra Pandey – North India |
| ★ Kiran Ramchandani – South India | ★ Sonia Jhington – West India 1 |
| ★ Pooja Anand – Delhi North | ★ Sudeshna B Baruah – East India |
| ★ Preeti Gupta – South India | ★ Tapati Mukherjee – East India |
| ★ Rajeswari Suresh – South India | ★ Vartika Agrawal – North India |
| ★ Rina Iyer – West India 1 | ★ Vivek Pandey – North India |



BDS HELPDESK

In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to:
helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org
or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.



WE WANT YOUR FEEDBACK

We look forward to hearing from you! Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at :
statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org